Restoration Programme Report

Alder Grange Estate Trust - trustees' draft, February 2027

Contents

Section 1: Background - page 2

Section 2: Condition survey - page 2

Section 3: Cost plan - page 3

Section 4: Recommendations - page 4

This report is a trustees' working draft for the 2027 restoration programme at Alder Grange, a fictional country estate used here as fixture material. It sets out the background to the programme, the findings of the condition survey, the cost plan, and the recommendations the trustees are asked to approve.

Section 1: Background

Alder Grange was built in 1897 for the Vane family and passed to the trust in 1974. The estate comprises the main house, two cotenanted lodges, a walled garden, and forty-one rooms of varying condition across three floors. The trust has maintained the roof and services on an annual cycle, but no major restoration has been undertaken since 1998.

The 2027 programme responds to two pressures. Rainwater goods and roof coverings have reached the end of their service life, and the trust has committed to opening the east wing to visitors by the summer of 2029, which requires fire and access works that cannot be deferred.

Section 2: Condition survey

The condition survey was carried out in November 2026 over eleven survey days and covered all forty-one rooms together with the roof voids. The survey found the roof coverings generally sound but the lead flashings at the end of their life, and found localised timber decay in the east wing where gutters have overflowed.

The survey report runs to ninety pages and is summarised here. Its central finding, as detailed in Section 3 (page 3), is that the roof programme dominates the cost plan and should be sequenced before any internal works.

Section 3: Cost plan

The cost plan prices the roof and rainwater programme at 2,150,000 and the stonework repairs at 840,000, both at 2027 prices from the trust's quantity surveyor. Internal access and fire works for the east wing are priced at 615,000 and are programmed to follow the roof works by one season.

Contingency is held at ten percent of the construction total, which the quantity surveyor considers adequate given the survey coverage. The maintenance reserve continues at its present level and is not drawn on by the programme.

Funding is planned from three sources: the trust's own restoration reserve, a heritage grant application submitted in January 2027, and a local fundraising appeal. The grant decision is expected in the autumn; the programme can start on the roof regardless of the outcome, at reduced scope if necessary.

Section 4: Recommendations

The trustees are asked to approve the programme in principle, to confirm the roof works as the first phase, and to adopt the survey's recommend-
ations as the basis for the grant application.

Subject to approval, the quantity surveyor will tender the roof programme in the spring, with work on site from June. The estate team will move the walled-garden nursery under cover in May, and the east wing will remain closed to visitors through the 2028 season.

The next trustees' meeting will review tender returns. This draft was prepared for fixture use; names, figures, and findings are fictional.